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node.js, express, how to get data from body form-data in post request

Asked 3 years, 10 months ago Modified 2 years, 1 month ago Viewed 48k times



I have a simple node.js app. I want to get post body from user.

22 app.js



```
var express = require('express');
var app = express();

app.use(express.json());

app.post('/api/user', function (req, res) {
  console.log(req.body);
  console.log(req.body.username);
});

module.exports = app;
```

server.js

```
var app = require('./app.js');

var server = app.listen(3000, function () {

  var port = server.address().port;

  console.log('Web App Hosted at http://localhost:%s',port);

});
```

When i launch it with `node server.js`, its fine. When i check it with postman,

 [enter image description here](#)

in console, it returns

```
Web App Hosted at http://localhost:3000
{}
undefined
```

I have the newest express.

And i have try other thing like add `body-parser`, add header to `content-type`, add

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javascript

node.js

express

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edited Sep 29, 2020 at 10:00

asked Jun 25, 2019 at 16:17



alfianrehanusa

alfian 1,344 ● 2 ● 15 ● 30

Possible duplicate of [What does body-parser do with express?](#) – zero298 Jun 25, 2019 at 16:21

@zero298 i think is not, because i use the newest express. So i no need body-parser – alfianrehanusa Jun 26, 2019 at 2:15

6 Answers

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after hours, i found it.

56

body-parser its not required because in newest express is included.

i have found how to get form-data, it require multer(for parsing multipart/form data) middleware. i have found it in [here](#).

first install multer



```
npm install multer --save
```

import multer in your app. for example in my code

```
var express = require('express');
var app = express();
var multer = require('multer');
var upload = multer();

// for parsing application/json
app.use(express.json());

// for parsing application/x-www-form-urlencoded
app.use(express.urlencoded({ extended: true }));

// for parsing multipart/form-data
app.use(upload.array());
app.use(express.static('public'));

app.post('/api/user', function (req, res) {
  console.log(req.body);
});
```

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```
module.exports = app;
```

so, it can receive form-data, raw, or x-www-form-urlencoded.

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edited Mar 24, 2021 at 1:48

answered Jun 26, 2019 at 7:09



[alfianrehanusa](#)

[alfian](#) 1,344 ● 2 ● 15 ● 30

- 7 I have also had the same issue and spend 3 hours trying to figure out what went wrong. Finally, I also forgot to include my multer function in my routes :) – [Alisher Musurmonov](#) Dec 20, 2019 at 5:17

you need install **body-parser** to parse req.body

4

```
var bodyParser = require("body-parser");
app.use(bodyParser.json());
app.use(bodyParser.urlencoded({ extended: true }));
```

body-parser extract the entire body portion of an incoming request stream and exposes it on req.body.

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answered Jun 25, 2019 at 16:19



[Ghoul Ahmed](#)

[Ghou](#) 4,396 ● 1 ● 14 ● 23

- 4 There is a screenshot in the question, where it can be seen that @alfian5229 sends a form-data request, not json. So `express.json()` is useless there. – [poohitan](#) Jun 25, 2019 at 16:41

@Shubh yeah, and i have the newest express. – [alfianrehanusa](#) Jun 26, 2019 at 1:34

Express specifies in their [API docs](#) that you have to use one of the provided middlewares to give the body a value. They made this decision because there are many different kinds of formats HTTP request bodies can take, and they don't want to assume which one your app uses.

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answered Jun 25, 2019 at 16:20



[piticent123](#)

193 ● 1 ● 7

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